Rahul Sharma

Project Lead | Game Testing & Project Management

I lead game testing and release management for international studios, owning scope, schedule, staffing, stakeholder communication and the final go/no-go call across PC, console, mobile and web. I work in the QA Department at IGT Solutions, where I lead a team of up to 10 QA engineers.

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3000+	40+	14,784 h	7	Up to 10
QA deliverables managed across PC, console, mobile and web	game projects tested and released live	structured testing effort across 1,848 days	successful, revenue-generating international clients	testers trained and mentored across all projects

Leadership highlights

- **Release gatekeeping.** On Buluk Mayan Warfare, I called a No-Go from the defect data, with 15 of 24 S1 (Highest) and S2 (High) defects unresolved, and set out a P0/P1/P2 fix plan (page 2).
- **Incident ownership.** On Jewel Match Solitaire Seasons CE, a client-side user found defects we had missed. I led the incident report and root-cause analysis, and we rebuilt compatibility coverage around the gap (page 3).
- **Crunch and churn control.** Under deadline pressure, I re-scope to a risk-based critical path in writing and protect regression testing. When testers join or leave mid-project, documented test cases and paired first build cycles maintain coverage (page 4).

Areas of ownership as Project Lead

Project delivery	Release management	People leadership
Scope, schedule, staffing and client communication from kickoff to written closure; weekly status reports; hours tracked against plan	Builds promoted through dev, beta and release-candidate stages; go/no-go against written exit criteria; verification of the live build	A team of up to 10 QA engineers: daily allocation, onboarding with paired first cycles, a structured training plan and yearly Team Pivot goals

Career and shipped titles

Period	Company and role	Platforms	Titles shipped (selected)
Jun 2023 – Present	**IGT Solutions, Gurgaon** — Project Lead, Game Testing	PC / Steam, mobile, web	Buluk Mayan Warfare (AA), Jewel Match Solitaire Seasons CE, Jewel Match Origins 3, Chronicles of Albian 3, Tales of Lagoona, Runefall 3 and Belote Bistro (mobile), among 40+ live releases
Mar 2023 – Jun 2023	**Passage.io, USA** — Senior QA Analyst (freelance, remote)	PC	Passage World Building (blockchain / NFT metaverse)
Jul 2022 – Feb 2023	**Passion Gaming, Gurgaon** — Senior Quality Analyst	PC / web	Rummy Passion (real-money iGaming)
Jul 2021 – Jul 2022	**Indium Software, Bengaluru** — Testing Engineer, Level 2	Mobile	CSR 2 (drag racing), iGaming slot titles
Jul 2019 – Jul 2021	**Ubisoft Entertainment, Pune** — Game Tester, QA/QC	PS4 / Xbox / PC	For Honor (AAA)
Dec 2018 – Jun 2019	**U2opia Mobile; I-Tuple Technologies** — QA internships	Mobile, web / API	Milk Basket

Recognition: Spot Award for Active Testing Excellence (Indium Software); 1st Runner-Up, Battleground QA Event 2020 (Ubisoft). **Education:** B.Tech, Computer Science (2017).

Toolkit: Jira (project lead and administrator), TestRail, Unity, Unreal Engine 5, MS Excel (dashboards, pivots, RTM), Agile / Scrum and Waterfall delivery; functional, regression, compatibility, progression, exploratory, localisation and live-build testing.

Client, studio and colleague names are anonymised under NDA. Figures are reproduced from source Jira exports and daily logs.

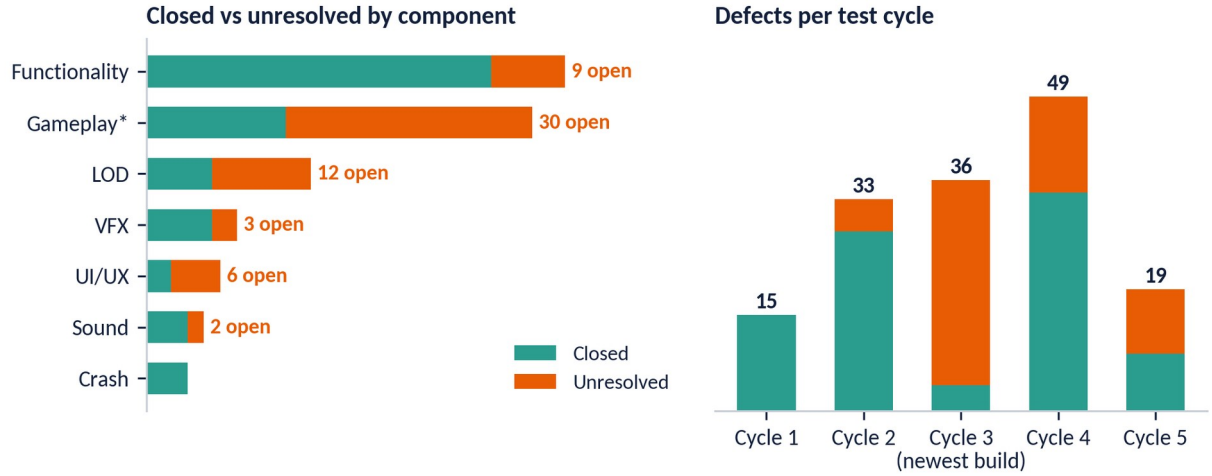
Case study 1: Buluk Mayan Warfare — No-Go release verdict

Live on Steam · PC AA action campaign title · My role: Project Lead · Team size: 3 testers

152	59%	15 / 24	0 / 5	84%
defects across 5 test cycles	closed (90 of 152)	S1 (Highest) and S2 (High) defects still unresolved	crash defects open	of defects held by one developer

Verdict: No-Go for release sign-off. Build stability was acceptable: all 5 crash defects and every blocker were closed. The risk was functional and concentrated in late-game boss and AI behaviour, level-progression exploits and save-data integrity. The newest build had 32 of its 36 defects unresolved, so its fix-and-verify phase had not started.

Exit criteria: 1 of 5 met. Passed: no open crash or blocker defects. Failed: open S1 (Highest) defects (2), open S2 (High) defects (13), closure rate (59.2% against a 90% target) and unverified reopens (6).



Closed versus unresolved defects by component, and defects per test cycle. Source: Jira defect export (152 defects).

Triage decisions: where I directed engineering focus

Bucket	Scope	Direction to engineering
P0: show-stoppers, fix now	4 defects: post-level flow sends the player to the start page (reopened); save data destroyed on new game; two level-skip exploits	Fix and verify before the next candidate build; add regression for progression and save data
P1: boss and AI combat	9 defects: idle bots, boss standing still, enemies dying without attack, cannons reactivating after a checkpoint reload	Isolate the shared enemy-AI state root cause; a small number of fixes is likely to resolve most of these tickets
P2: reopened and open backlog	5 reopened and 8 open or new defects	Re-verify why fixes failed retest; assign owners; group 11 collision and LOD issues into one pass

Delivery risks raised beyond the defect list

- **Single point of failure.** One developer held 127 of 152 defects and all 62 unresolved ones. I flagged this in the triage report as a risk to the release schedule.
- **Weak triage data.** 82% of defects sat at Medium priority, and 84 of 90 closed defects had no resolution value. These findings shaped the Jira configuration I set up afterwards, with mandatory triage fields, so release decisions rest on cleaner data.

Outcome. The client received a release position backed by data, with a ranked fix plan for the next candidate build. Buluk Mayan Warfare later shipped and is live on Steam.

Case study 2: Jewel Match Solitaire Seasons CE — risk recovery

Live on Steam · Casual card-puzzle PC title with a Collector's Edition · My role: Project Lead · Team size: up to 5 testers

Area	Detail
Team scale	Up to 5 core dedicated QA engineers, scaled up to 10 QA Department reporters for the final multi-configuration smoke and regression passes
Effort	43 days and 576 hours of structured testing across pre-production and the live phase
Environments	Windows 10 and 11, from Core i5 / 8 GB laptops to Ryzen 9 / 32 GB machines; pre-production builds, then live in September
Output	212 defects logged, 31 build versions tested, 204 documented test cases; 186 of 197 executed cases passed at the July checkpoint (94.4%)
Defect data	Built a de-duplication protocol that condensed 466 raw daily-log status lines into 212 unique, actionable defects, removing over 54% of reporting noise so triage and client reporting ran on one clean count

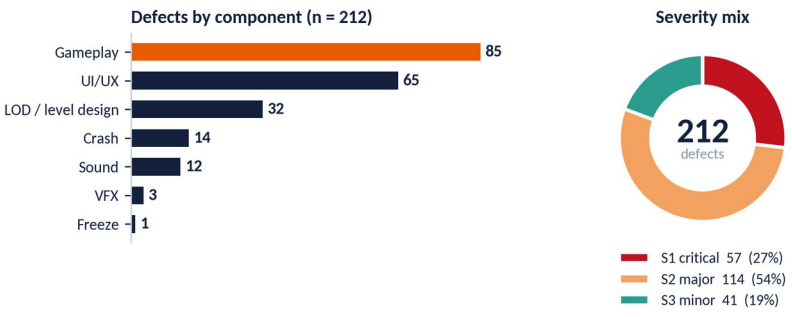
The incident

Date	What happened	How we handled it
13 Jul 2024	A client-side user on the beta build reported screen-resolution and aspect-ratio defects, outdated help-file content, misplaced text at high resolution, overflowing piles in a bonus game and a missing confirmation on "Try Again" (S2).	We reviewed each report and raised new tickets the same day; escalated to leadership; resolution time recorded as 1 day.
26 Jul 2024	Bonus levels de-synchronised and crashed between the Standard and Collector's Editions.	Recorded as missed in testing; the cross-edition bonus path was not part of the regular test flow.

Root cause. The compatibility matrix did not include a full resolution and aspect-ratio sweep or the cross-edition bonus path, so a mid-game resolution change was never exercised. Impact recorded: medium reputational risk, no penalty, rework required.

Framework corrections I introduced

Gap	Correction	Result
Resolution and aspect ratio not in the matrix	Dedicated compatibility suite of 29 cases: aspect ratios 4:3, 16:9 and 16:10; resolutions from 800x600 to 1920x1080	Sweeps logged in the daily report from 27 Aug 2024
Interrupts tested informally	Formal interrupt suite of 7 cases	Part of the test set by project close
Cross-edition bonus path outside the flow	Bonus-level series re-run in seven rounds on successive beta builds	Covered Jul–Aug before go-live
Live build not re-verified	Live-environment pass after release	Completed in September
Plan not agreed up front	New roadmap, checklist, scenarios and test cases issued with the test plan	Now signed off by the client before each project starts



212 unique defects by component and severity. Source: daily report bug log (466 status lines de-duplicated).

Outcome. The corrected compatibility and bonus-level passes ran before go-live, and the title was released live in September 2024. Resolution, aspect ratio and older hardware are now standard in my test plans from day one, and I agree the compatibility matrix with the client before testing starts.

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Process optimisation and operational efficiency

Three areas I manage on every engagement: requirements coverage, delivery controls and team goals. Together they keep coverage complete, defect leakage visible and testing effort proportionate to risk.

1. Requirements traceability audit

Audit of the requirements traceability matrix on Jewel Match Solitaire Seasons CE, with each requirement classified as direct, partial or gap coverage.

25	15	5	3	2
requirement mappings re-audited	directly covered, incl. one re-scoped to PC	partially covered	coverage gaps found	mobile-only, marked out of scope

Finding	Action taken
Several requirements were mapped to the wrong test case, and test-case IDs were duplicated across sheets	Moved every mapping to unique, module-prefixed IDs, for example, GP-TC02 and SHOP-TC05
Three requirements were carried over from a mobile project into a PC-only scope	Marked two mobile-only requirements out of scope and re-scoped the third to the 29-case compatibility suite
Key risk: the next-level unlock rule had no dedicated test case, and three of the first nine defects logged were level-unlock errors	Raised new test cases for all three gaps: card types, auto-save and the next-level unlock rule

2. Operating controls and their effect on delivery

Control	Effect on delivery (with data)
Headcount matched to project phase	Core team scaled up for the final smoke and regression passes and down for live monitoring, so effort follows risk: 576 hours across 43 days on Jewel Match Solitaire Seasons CE
Documented cases as the handover mechanism	204 test cases and 53 module-level checks allow a new tester to take over live coverage within one day, so team changes do not reduce coverage
Written, risk-based re-scoping during crunch	Deferred scope is agreed with the client in writing, and regression testing is never compressed
Escape tracking through incident reports	Two escapes on Jewel Match Solitaire Seasons CE, both analysed in an incident report; defect leakage is tracked as a Team Pivot goal with a 15% weight
Data reconciliation before reporting	Buluk Mayan Warfare figures recomputed from the Jira export and matched to the triage report; Jewel Match Solitaire Seasons CE bug log de-duplicated (page 3)

3. Team Pivot: yearly goals I monitor



Pillar (weight)	Focus areas	How I monitor it
Performance (30%)	Bug identification and reporting; test accuracy and coverage; UX, functional and regression feedback	Logged bugs reviewed against the reporting standard; RTM coverage reviews
Initiative (20%)	Test process improvement; game progression; gameplay experience suggestions	Reusable checklists and suites; level-by-level progression logs
Value (30%)	Productivity and utilisation; defect leakage to UAT and production; process adherence	Time logged per module; escapes tracked through incident reports; mandatory Jira fields
Outreach (10%)	Stakeholder feedback	Daily bug status and weekly reports to the client
Talent (10%)	Annual certifications; career development	Learning plan and certification status tracked per tester

Work blueprint

Window	Focus	Outcome
Days 1–30: understand	Read the game design document, map the build pipeline, review existing defect data and the Jira set-up, play through every game mode	A baseline: closure rate, reopen rate, defect ageing and escape history
Days 31–60: standardise	Bug report standard, severity and priority as separate mandatory fields, one lifecycle, a hardware and resolution matrix, entry and exit criteria	One trusted defect dataset and a signed-off test plan
Days 61–90: scale	Reusable regression suites for progression, save/load and AI; a daily and weekly reporting rhythm; first automation candidates	Faster build verification and a repeatable go/no-go report

Metrics I report on the QA dashboard

Metric	Why it matters	My baseline
Defect closure rate and ageing	Shows whether the backlog is shrinking	Buluk Mayan Warfare: 59.2% closed, median unresolved age 35 days
Reopen rate	Fix quality	Buluk Mayan Warfare: 3.9%
Escaped defects (found after handover)	Direct measure of test effectiveness	Jewel Match Solitaire Seasons CE: two escapes, both analysed
Test-case pass rate per build	Build health	Jewel Match Solitaire Seasons CE checkpoint: 94.4%
Ownership spread	Delivery risk	Buluk Mayan Warfare: 84% of defects with one developer

Artifacts available to technical panels

Artifact	Where to find it
Test plan, testing procedure, test scenarios, 204 test cases, RTM (original and audited)	Available in the Master Portfolio
Daily report workbook (19 sheets), game checklist, observation log	Available in the Master Portfolio
Jira defect export (152 defects); bug triage and test summary	Available in the Master Portfolio
Incident report, postmortem, testing closure and handover	Available in the Master Portfolio
Bug reporting SOP, Jira workflow and field configuration	Available in the Master Portfolio
Edge-case workbooks and Team Pivot yearly goals workbook	Available in the Master Portfolio
Master Portfolio: full methodology, Jira administration and source documents (24 pages)	GitHub (link below)

Next step

Open to future opportunities. Please visit my Master Portfolio on GitHub to see my work, with attachments and a more detailed account of my entire journey.

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